

QUESTIONS FROM CDS EXAM (2012-2016)

2012 (I)

PASSAGE 1

Our voyage was very prosperous, but I shall not trouble the reader with a journal of it. The captain called in at one or two ports and sent in his long-boat for provisions and fresh water, but I never went out of the ship till we came into the Downs, which was on the 3rd day of June, 1706, about nine months after my escape. I offered to leave my goods in security for payment of my freight, but the captain protested he would not receive one farthing.

We took kind leave of each other, and I made him promise that he would come to see me at my house in Redriff. I hired a house and a guide for five shillings which I borrowed from the captain.

- When the writer uses the word 'prosperous' to describe the voyage, he means that
 - it made him rich
 - it made him healthy
 - it was very pleasant
 - it was uneventful
- On the voyage, the author
 - left the ship at intervals
 - was not able to leave the ship because it did not stop
 - never left the ship at all
 - never left the ship till they came into the Downs
- In the context of the passage, the word 'provisions' means
 - mainly food
 - mainly security
 - money
 - mainly ammunition
- For the payment of the author's freight, the captain
 - kept his goods as security
 - refused to accept any money
 - protested against being paid only a farthing
 - accepted a sum of money
- From the passage, it is clear that the captain's attitude to the author was
 - one of hostility
 - one of indifference
 - one of extreme friendliness and kindness
 - one of disgust and irritation

PASSAGE 2

What were the early ideas of men about the sky and the Earth? They naturally believed that the Earth was motionless, and they also supposed that it was flat. These two ideas do not surprise us. Children now-a-days think the same until they are taught differently. How were men to know that the Earth was a ball circling round the Sun? They had no telescope for accurate observation. They had not travelled round the world. In fact many parts of the world in those days were unexplored and unknown. They lived on a kind of flat plate, and that the sky with the Sun and the Moon and the stars, was a kind of inverted bowl turning round above them. The Sun, the Moon and the stars were their lamps for day and night.

- Unless children are taught differently they think that
 - the Earth is round and moving
 - the Sun and the Moon are motionless
 - the Sun and the Moon are moving
 - the Sun and the Moon are moving round the Earth
- The early ideas of man were wrong because
 - man did not use the telescope
 - man did not like to travel
 - man never had the scientific knowledge
 - man was foolish and lazy
- What was true for the early man?
 - The Earth was round and moving
 - The telescope was accurate
 - Travelling and exploring were the methods to gain knowledge
 - The Sun was motionless
- What was the main cause of the early man's wrong ideas?
 - Lack of scientific knowledge
 - Seeing and believing
 - Lack of desire to know
 - Lack of desire to observe and explore

PASSAGE 3

The man sat-up in the snow for a moment and struggled for calmness. Then, he pulled on his gloves by means of his teeth and got upon his feet. He glanced down at first in order to assure himself that he was really standing up, for the absence of sensation in his feet left him unrelated to the Earth. His erect position in itself started to drive the webs of suspicion from the dog's mind and when he spoke peremptorily, with the sound of whip-lashes in his voice, the dog rendered its customary allegiance and came to him.

As it came within reaching distance, the man lost his control. His arms flashed out to the dog and he experienced genuine surprise when he discovered that his hands could not clutch, that there was neither bend nor feeling in the fingers. He had forgotten for the moment that they were frozen and that they were freezing more and more. All this happened quickly and before the animal could get away, he encircled its body with his arms. He sat down in the snow and in this fashion held the dog, while it snarled and whined and struggled.

- 10.** From the passage, which group of words expresses the effect of snow upon the man's feet?
- With the sound of whip-lashes in his voice
 - His arms flashed out to the dog
 - The absence of sensation in his feet left him unrelated to the Earth
 - The man sat up in the snow for a moment and struggled for calmness
- 11.** The statement that the man experienced genuine surprise when he discovered that his hands could not clutch means that
- the man did not see anything to clutch
 - the man had nothing to clutch
 - the man was afraid of the dog
 - there was neither bend nor feeling in the fingers
- 12.** Which word or group of words shows the exact condition of being 'frozen'?
- Whip-lashes in his voice
 - He pulled on his gloves
 - His hands could not clutch
 - Lost his control

PASSAGE 4

George was a young man who had gone to the big city from a small rural community and, in a relatively short time attained prominence in the business world. His sudden rise had gone into his head, however, and he became unbearably conceited.

Eventually, George returned home after a visit, halfway expecting everyone in town to be at the railway station to welcome him. Much to his surprise, George saw that no one, not even his family, was around to meet him when he descended from the train. He looked very neat in a new suit and carried a bulky suitcase full of fashionable clothes.

After a little while, the station master came from his office and went over to the young fellow. 'Well, hello there, George,' he called out cheerly, 'Are you going away?'

- 13.** The station master's question implied that
- he offered help to George in climbing the train
 - he is known to George very intimately
 - he is making fun of George
 - George's absence from the town was not noticed by him

- 14.** George hoped for a big welcome because
- of his achievement and success
 - he is returning home after a very long time
 - people loved him
 - his community wanted dynamic leaders like him
- 15.** George's great expectations are an indication of his
- humility
 - optimism
 - pride
 - love of his community
- 16.** George's success was most clearly visible in
- the station master's words
 - his clothes
 - his being unbearably conceited
 - the manner in which he was received by the village

PASSAGE 5

The assault on the purity of the environment is the price that we pay for many of the benefits of modern technology. For the advantages of automative transportation we pay a price in smog-induced diseases; for the powerful effects of new insecticides, we pay a price in dwindling wildlife and disturbances in the relation of living things and their surroundings; for nuclear power, we risk the biological hazards of radiation. By increasing agricultural production with fertilizers, we increase water pollution. The highly developed nations of the world are not only the immediate beneficiaries of the good that technology can do, they are also the first victims of the environmental diseases that technology breeds.

In the past, the environmental effects which accompanied technological progress were restricted to a small place and relatively a short time. The new hazards are neither local nor brief. Modern air pollution covers vast areas of continents. Radioactive fall out from nuclear explosions is worldwide. Radioactive pollutants now on the Earth's surface will be found there for generations, and in the case of carbon 14 for thousands of years.

- 17.** The passage emphasises that modern technology
- is totally avoidable
 - has caused serious hazards to life
 - has greater effect on developed countries
 - is the source of the miseries of mankind
- 18.** The harmful effects of modern technology are
- widespread but shortlived
 - widespread and long lasting
 - local and long lasting
 - severe but shortlived
- 19.** With reference to the passage, the following assumptions have been made
- The widespread use of insecticides has caused ecological disturbances.
 - Conservation of natural flora and fauna is impossible in this age of modern technology.

Which of the assumption(s) given above is/are valid?

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

PASSAGE 6

To what extent, though, are modern farming methods sustainable? There is abundant evidence that a high price has to be paid to sustain the high rates of food production achieved by farmed monocultures, e.g. they offer ideal conditions for the epidemic spread of diseases such as mastitis brucellosis and swine fever among livestock and coccidiosis among poultry. Farmed animals are normally kept at densities far higher than their species would meet in nature with the result that disease transmission rates are magnified.

In addition high rates of transmission between herds occur as animals are sold from one farming enterprise to another, and it is easy for the farmers themselves, with mud on their boots and their vehicles, to act as vector of pests and disease.

20. With reference to the passage, consider the following statements

1. The modern practices of farming are undesirable for developing countries.
2. Monoculture practices should be given up to eliminate disease transmission in animals.

Which of the statement(s) given above is/are correct?

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

21. What is the essence of this passage?

- (a) Farming is a very costly affair
- (b) Farmed animals are kept at higher densities in monocultures
- (c) There is a widespread transmission of animal diseases now-a-days
- (d) Human dependence on monoculture is fragile

2012 (II)

PASSAGE 7

Sit down, the Principal said, but Mr Tagde continued to stand, gaining courage from his own straight-backed stance, because he was beginning to feel a little afraid now. The Principal looked unhappy. He disliked being forced to perform this sort of an unpleasant task.

'I wish you would consider withdrawing this report', he said. 'I am sorry, Sir, I cannot do that', Mr Tagde said. He was pleased with his unwavering voice and uncompromising words.

'It will be a very damaging report if put on record.'

'It is a factual report on very damaging conduct.'

'You are asking for the boy's expulsion from school. Don't you think, the punishment is too harsh for a few boyish pranks?'

22. Mr Tagde did not sit down because

- (a) he was angry with the Principal
- (b) he was in a defiant mood
- (c) he did not like the student
- (d) he was in a hurry

23. He would not withdraw the report because

- (a) he was arrogant and bitter
- (b) it was an accurate report
- (c) he wanted to create problems for the Principal
- (d) he wanted to show his authority

24. The Principal was unhappy because he

- (a) did not like to deal with an arrogant person
- (b) was angry with Mr Tagde
- (c) could not enforce discipline in school
- (d) did not want to expel the boy

PASSAGE 8

It was a bitterly cold night, and even at the far end of the bus, the East wind that raved along the street cut like a knife. The bus stopped, the two women and a man got in together and filled the vacant places.

The younger woman was dressed in sealskin and carried one of those Pekinese dogs that women in sealskin like to carry in their laps. The conductor came in and took the fares. Then his eye rested with cold malice on the beady-eyed toy dog. I saw trouble brewing. This was the opportunity for which he had been waiting, and he intended to make the most of it.

25. The wind that blew on the night was

- (a) mild
- (b) pleasant
- (c) bitter
- (d) sharp

26. The younger woman was carrying the dog as

- (a) a necessity
- (b) a fashion
- (c) an expression of provocation
- (d) an escort

27. Which of the following statements best describes the nature of the conductor?

- (a) He was dutiful
- (b) He was a law-abiding person
- (c) He liked dogs
- (d) He was unfriendly and malicious

28. 'It was a bitterly cold night, and even at the far end of the bus, the East wind that raved along the street cut like a knife'. This sentence gives us an idea of

- (a) a lonely nightbus journey
- (b) an unbearable cold night
- (c) the wind at the time that was still and cold
- (d) the hardship of author's journey

PASSAGE 9

Before an armed robber locked Mary Graves in the sweltering trunk of her car, she dialled an emergency number on her portable telephone and slipped it to her three years old daughter. Though confused, the little girl saved the day. She told emergency operators that her mother was locked in the trunk. Although, she didn't know where she was, she provided some important clues-she could see airplanes and the sky, according to the transcript of the emergency phone call. The operator called Tampa International Airport Police, who searched the top floor of the airport parking garage where the car was parked. The operator told the girl to honk, enabling the police to locate the car and free Mrs Graves.

- 29.** The clues provided by the little girl suggest that the car was parked
- outside but adjacent to the airport
 - by the main street of the city
 - at the airport
 - in a parking garage in the sidelane
- 30.** The passage indicates that the girl was
- clever and brave
 - had the maturity of an adult
 - coy and shy
 - worried and excited
- 31.** The girl helped the police trace the car by
- shouting loudly
 - making too much din
 - shrieking frightfully
 - sounding the horn
- 32.** Through the passage, the writer suggests the importance and utility of
- education of little children
 - parking garages
 - portable telephones
 - airports

PASSAGE 10

For days I trudged from one property dealer to another, from one 'to-let' notice to another with the estimated advance money tucked safely in the inner lining of my handbag, but in vain. At one place, they needed a couple, at another a young man, and at another they wished to know my employment status. And I realised that I was a freak called the single woman and the job status being nothing more than a freelance writer with hardly any assignments in hand, only dreams of making it some day. So, the dream-house remained far away, gradually turning into a fantasy.

- 33.** The author 'trudged from one property dealer to another' means that the author
- had to walk a lot of distance
 - had to do a brisk walk to save the time
 - visited several property dealers without any success
 - acquired a good knowledge about the property dealers of that area

- 34.** According to the passage, the author was

- a novelist
- an independent writer
- a publisher of journals
- an unemployed person

- 35.** Which of the following statements best reflects the underlying tone of the passage?

- People always let out their houses to well employed persons only
- People always let out their houses only to couples
- Single jobless woman, find it difficult to rent a house
- Women always dream of a house

PASSAGE 11

Martin had many little tricks highly entertaining to his son. On an evening, returning from the market, he would buy a paper mask, the head of a hissing dragon. He would put it on and knock at the door.

On opening the door, the boy would be terrified for a moment, but only for a moment, for he would soon remove it and the two would roll with laughter. Tom would, then, go out with the mask and knock at the door for his father to open. Martin had to act as if he was paralysed with fear.

- 36.** Martin played his little tricks because

- he was very much interested in them
- he wanted to terrify his son
- his son got pleasure from them
- it was his habit to make tricks

- 37.** Which of the following statements is the most appropriate description of the mask?

- It is a mask looking like a dragon with long tail and covering the whole body of Martin
- It is a mask looking like the head of a dragon with its tongue hanging out
- It is a mask looking like an animal with horns, wings and a pair of ferocious eyes emitting fire
- It is a mask looking like the head of a King Cobra

- 38.** The father and son rolled with laughter after the

- father put on the mask
- opening of the door
- son saw the mask
- father removed the mask

2013 (I)

PASSAGE 12

Galileo desired to use his telescope to make more discoveries in the heavens, but his instrument was too small. He made another and larger telescope which magnified eight times and then another which magnified thirty times and pointed it at the Moon. His heart leaped with joy, for he saw what no human eye had ever before seen-ranges of mountains, deep hollows and broad plains! He turned his telescope on the planets and found they appeared with disks like the Moon at a quarter full. He turned it on the Milky Way and beheld innumerable tiny stars.

- 39.** Galileo made several telescopes because
 (a) he needed all of them to explore the heavens
 (b) he wanted to compare the findings obtained from different telescopes
 (c) the earlier ones he made were not powerful enough
 (d) only some of them could magnify the stars
- 40.** When Galileo saw what no human eye had ever before seen he
 (a) was overjoyed (b) was shocked
 (c) felt humble (d) was very proud

PASSAGE 13

My father was passionate about two things : education and socialism. He was himself a born teacher. Indeed, he could never restrain himself from teaching and as a small boy I was frequently embarrassed by his desire to instruct everybody-people in railway carriages, for instance-though I realised even then that it was an innocent desire, quite free from vanity.

He was equally ready to receive instruction. Education, to men of his generation and temperament, was something it has largely ceased to be now-a-days. It was the great golden gateway to the enchanted realms of the mind.

- 41.** The author wants us to know that his father
 (a) was a school teacher
 (b) was an educationist and socialist
 (c) used to travel a lot
 (d) loved teaching
- 42.** The author often felt embarrassed by the behaviour of his father because
 (a) he taught badly
 (b) he taught even at odd places
 (c) he wanted to show off his learning
 (d) he lost self-control while teaching
- 43.** To the generation of the writer's father, education was
 (a) an old fashioned enterprise
 (b) the result of good teaching
 (c) an exploration of the world of imagination
 (d) one aspect of socialism
- 44.** From the passage, it is clear that the author
 (a) loved and admired his father
 (b) disapproved his father's love of teaching
 (c) thought of him as vain
 (d) considered his father's education inadequate

PASSAGE 14

We started looking on the ground for blood, hair, or a drag mark that would lead us to the deer killed by the tiger. We had proceeded a hundred yards, examining every foot of the ground and going dead slow, when Mothi, just as I turned my head to look at him, started backwards, screaming as he did so.

Then, he whipped round and ran for dear life, beating the air with his hands as if warding off a swarm of bees and continuing to scream as he ran. The sudden and piercing scream of a human being in a jungle where a moment before all has been silent is terrifying to hear. Instinctively, I knew what had happened. With his eyes fixed on the ground, looking for the blood or hair of the kill, Mothi had failed to see where he was going and had walked towards the tiger.

- 45.** Mothi and the narrator were scanning the ground because
 (a) they were looking for the tiger
 (b) the forest was full of unpleasant surprises
 (c) they were trying to discover the tiger's footprints
 (d) they were looking for marks left by the tiger's prey
- 46.** Mothi began to scream when he
 (a) was attacked by a swarm of bees
 (b) was frightened by the sight of blood
 (c) came face to face with the tiger
 (d) stumbled on the tiger
- 47.** In the context of the passage, 'kill' means
 (a) the act of killing
 (b) an animal killed by the tiger
 (c) a human being killed by the tiger
 (d) a wounded tiger
- 48.** Before Mothi screamed, the jungle was
 (a) quiet (b) dark
 (c) noisy (d) terrifying

PASSAGE 15

When Ibbotson returned from Pauri, I told him of the leopard's habit of going down the road between Rudraprayag and Golabrai on an average once in every five days. I convinced him that the only hope I now had of shooting the man-eater was by sitting over the road for ten nights, for, the leopard would be almost certain to use the road at least once during the period. Ibbotson agreed to my plan reluctantly, for I had already sat-up many nights and he was afraid that another ten nights on end would be too much for me.

- 49.** Ibbotson was reluctant to agree to the narrator's plan because he was afraid that
 (a) the leopard would kill him
 (b) the narrator would become very tired
 (c) the narrator would kill the leopard
 (d) the leopard might not come
- 50.** The narrator wanted to
 (a) shoot the leopard
 (b) see the leopard
 (c) capture the leopard
 (d) frighten the leopard